



ABHISHEK G

Senior Network Engineer | Cloud & Security

Network & Security Engineer | Cloud, Automation, SD-WAN

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY:

- Certified **Senior Network Engineer** | Remote Ready with **8+ years** of experience in network design, security, cloud networking, and automation.
- Expertise in routing, switching, **SD-WAN, VPNs, and firewalls (Palo Alto, Checkpoint, Cisco ASA, Fortinet, Juniper SRX)** for securing and optimizing enterprise networks.
- Skilled in remote network operations, troubleshooting, and automation using **Python, Ansible, and Terraform**, ensuring high availability and security compliance (ISO 27001, NIST).
- Hands-on experience in cloud networking (**AWS VPC, Azure ExpressRoute, Direct Connect**), managing hybrid cloud infrastructures for secure remote access.
- Proficient in load balancing (**F5 LTM, GTM, Citrix NetScaler**), VPN security (**Cisco AnyConnect, GlobalProtect, Zscaler**), and remote collaboration tools (**Zoom, Teams, JIRA, Confluence**).
- Certified in **CCNP, AWS Solutions Architect, PCNSE**, with a proven track record of leading remote network operations, optimizing cloud security, and automating large-scale network deployments.

CERTIFICATIONS:

- Cisco Certified Network Associate (CCNA).
- Cisco Certified Network Professional (CCNP).(CSCO14869024)
- Azure Security Engineer Associate (AZ-500).
- Palo Alto Networks Certified Network Security Engineer (PCNSE).

TECHNICAL SKILLS:

Category	Skills
Routing & Switching	BGP, OSPF, EIGRP, VLAN, STP, HSRP, VRRP
Firewall Security	Palo Alto, Cisco ASA, Fortinet, Checkpoint, Juniper SRX
VPN Technologies	IPsec, SSL, Cisco AnyConnect, GlobalProtect, Zscaler
Load Balancing	F5 LTM/GTM, Citrix NetScaler
Wireless Networking	Cisco WLC, Aruba APs
Network Segmentation	VLANs, VRF, SDN
Network Monitoring&Troubleshooting	Wireshark, SolarWinds, NetFlow
Cloud Security & Compliance	Zero Trust, NIST, ISO 27001, PCI DSS
Network Automation	Python, Ansible, Terraform
SD-WAN	Cisco Viptela, SilverPeak
Azure	VNet, ExpressRoute, Azure Firewall
AWS	VPC, Direct Connect, Security Groups

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE:

Client: Citi – On-site (Dallas, TX)

Senior Network Security Engineer

Feb 2023 – Present

Network Security & Firewall Management

- Designed and implemented security policies for Palo Alto, Cisco ASA, and Checkpoint firewalls, ensuring compliance with ISO 27001 and NIST standards.

- Optimized firewall rules and VPN policies, reducing security threats by 40% and improving network performance.
- Conducted regular firewall audits using Panorama, Cisco FMC, and Ansible, automating policy updates and reducing manual workload by 50%.
- Performed intrusion prevention system (IPS) configurations to enhance threat detection and mitigation.
- Configured and monitored Palo Alto PA-3200, PA-5200, and PA-7000 series firewalls, ensuring robust perimeter security.

Cloud Networking & Hybrid Security

- Configured AWS VPC, Direct Connect, and Azure ExpressRoute, enabling secure hybrid cloud connectivity across global teams.
- Integrated Zero Trust security models across cloud and on-prem environments, ensuring secure access management for remote users.
- Deployed network segmentation policies (VRF, VLANs, SDN) to enhance isolation and compliance across multi-cloud environments.
- Managed and optimized multi-cloud security architectures, ensuring data protection and secure application access.

SD-WAN & Remote Connectivity

- Implemented and optimized SD-WAN solutions (Cisco Viptela, SilverPeak), improving WAN performance by 35% and reducing latency.
- Configured and managed VPN solutions (Cisco AnyConnect, Palo Alto GlobalProtect, Zscaler), ensuring secure remote access for 10,000+ users.
- Monitored and troubleshot SD-WAN fabric, ensuring optimal traffic flow and performance.

Network Automation & Troubleshooting

- Developed Python & Ansible automation scripts, reducing firewall change execution time by 60%.
- Monitored network performance using Wireshark, SolarWinds, and NetFlow, proactively identifying and mitigating potential issues.
- Led major incident resolution efforts, reducing downtime and improving network reliability to 99.99% uptime.
- Integrated API-based automation tools to enhance network provisioning and monitoring efficiency.

Infrastructure Upgrades & Compliance

- Migrated legacy network infrastructure to Cisco Nexus 9K, enhancing network speed, scalability, and security.
- Led compliance assessments and risk analysis for firewall, VPN, and cloud security policies, ensuring 100% regulatory compliance.
- Upgraded Cisco Catalyst 6500, 4500, and 9300 series switches, improving network performance and reliability.
- Implemented AAA authentication and TACACS+ security policies, ensuring secure access control.

Client: Freddie Mac – Hybrid (Dallas, TX)

Network Security Engineer

Jan 2021 - Jan 2023

Network Security & Firewall Management

- Configured, managed, and optimized Palo Alto (PA-3200, PA-5200) and Cisco ASA firewalls, improving security posture and reducing vulnerabilities.
- Implemented and fine-tuned firewall policies, reducing false positives and enhancing threat detection efficiency by 40%.
- Conducted firewall rule audits using Panorama and Cisco FMC, automating compliance checks and reducing manual efforts by 50%.
- Managed VPN solutions (GlobalProtect, Cisco AnyConnect, Zscaler) to secure remote access for enterprise-wide users.
- Deployed intrusion prevention systems (IPS) and content filtering solutions, preventing unauthorized access and malware threats.

Cloud Networking & Hybrid Infrastructure

- Configured and maintained AWS VPC, Azure ExpressRoute, and Direct Connect, ensuring seamless hybrid cloud connectivity.

- Integrated cloud security controls to protect sensitive data and ensure compliance with ISO 27001 and NIST standards.
- Implemented network segmentation (VRF, VLAN, SDN) to enhance security and performance in multi-cloud environments.
- Automated cloud security policies using Terraform and Ansible, reducing deployment time by 60%.

Remote Network Operations & SD-WAN Optimization

- Deployed and optimized SD-WAN solutions (Cisco Viptela, SilverPeak), improving application performance and reducing latency by 30%.
- Configured QoS policies to prioritize real-time applications, ensuring optimal VoIP and video conferencing quality for remote users.
- Monitored and troubleshot SD-WAN fabric, ensuring consistent connectivity for remote offices and global teams.

Network Automation & Remote Troubleshooting

- Developed automation scripts (Python, Ansible) to streamline firewall updates and reduce manual configuration time by 50%.
- Performed deep packet analysis using Wireshark, SolarWinds, and NetFlow, proactively identifying and resolving remote connectivity issues.
- Led critical incident management and root cause analysis, improving mean time to resolution (MTTR) by 35%, ensuring minimal disruption for remote users.

Infrastructure Upgrades & Compliance

- Led migration from legacy network infrastructure to Cisco Nexus 9K, increasing bandwidth and reducing operational costs.
- Ensured regulatory compliance (ISO 27001, NIST, PCI DSS) through rigorous network security audits and risk assessments.
- Upgraded core network infrastructure, implementing Cisco Catalyst 9500, 4500, and 9300 series switches for enhanced performance and scalability.
- Deployed AAA authentication (TACACS+, RADIUS) to strengthen identity and access management controls.

Client: IBM – Hybrid (Hyderabad, India)

Network Security Engineer

Jan 2019 - Dec 2020

Network Security & Firewall Management

- Configured, maintained, and optimized Palo Alto, Cisco ASA, and Checkpoint firewalls, enhancing security compliance and reducing vulnerabilities.
- Developed and enforced firewall security policies, ensuring adherence to ISO 27001, NIST, and PCI DSS standards.
- Managed VPN and remote access solutions (Cisco AnyConnect, GlobalProtect, Zscaler), providing secure connectivity for global remote teams.
- Conducted firewall rule audits using Panorama and Cisco FMC, automating compliance checks and reducing manual policy reviews by 50%.
- Implemented Intrusion Prevention Systems (IPS) and web filtering policies, improving threat prevention capabilities.

Cloud Networking & Hybrid Infrastructure

- Configured AWS VPC, Azure ExpressRoute, and Direct Connect, ensuring seamless hybrid cloud integration and security.
- Implemented multi-cloud security best practices, protecting sensitive enterprise data and ensuring network segmentation.
- Deployed Zero Trust security models, enhancing authentication and access controls for remote teams.
- Automated cloud security policies using Terraform and Ansible, reducing deployment errors and improving response time by 60%.

Remote Network Operations & SD-WAN Optimization

- Deployed and managed SD-WAN solutions (Cisco Viptela, SilverPeak), improving WAN performance and reducing network congestion by 30%.

- Configured QoS policies to optimize real-time applications, ensuring high-quality VoIP and video conferencing for remote users.
- Troubleshoot SD-WAN performance issues remotely, ensuring 99.99% uptime for global business operations.

Network Automation & Troubleshooting

- Developed Python and Ansible scripts to automate firewall updates, improving efficiency and reducing manual configurations by 50%.
- Conducted deep packet analysis using Wireshark, SolarWinds, and NetFlow, proactively identifying security threats and network inefficiencies.
- Led incident response and disaster recovery drills, ensuring network resilience and reducing downtime risk.

Infrastructure Upgrades & Compliance

- Upgraded network infrastructure with Cisco Nexus 9K and Catalyst 9500 series switches, improving network scalability and redundancy.
- Implemented AAA authentication (TACACS+, RADIUS) and security policies, enhancing identity and access management.
- Led compliance audits and security risk assessments, ensuring 100% regulatory compliance across network infrastructure.

Client: Global Edge – On-Site (Hyderabad, India)

Network Engineer

July 2016 - Dec 2018

Network Operations & Security

- Configured and maintained Cisco routers (2900, 3900 series) and switches (Catalyst 4500, 3750, 2960), optimizing LAN/WAN performance.
- Implemented firewall security policies on Cisco ASA and Fortinet firewalls, ensuring compliance with industry standards.
- Monitored network traffic using Wireshark and SolarWinds, proactively identifying and troubleshooting network issues.
- Configured and supported IPsec VPNs and SSL VPNs (Cisco AnyConnect, GlobalProtect) to ensure secure remote access.

Routing & Switching

- Configured dynamic routing protocols (BGP, OSPF, EIGRP) for optimized network performance and failover solutions.
- Implemented VLAN segmentation, STP, and EtherChannel, improving network security and traffic management.
- Deployed HSRP and VRRP for high availability, ensuring minimal downtime and redundancy.

Wireless & Load Balancing

- Configured and managed Cisco Wireless LAN Controllers (WLCs) and Aruba APs, improving wireless network coverage.
- Optimized application traffic flow using F5 LTM load balancers, ensuring efficient bandwidth utilization.
- Deployed QoS policies to prioritize business-critical applications, enhancing real-time communication performance.

Network Automation & Infrastructure Upgrades

- Developed Python scripts to automate network monitoring and configuration tasks, reducing manual workload by 30%.
- Led firmware upgrades for Cisco network devices, ensuring network security and performance optimization.
- Provided L2/L3 troubleshooting support for enterprise networks, ensuring smooth IT operations and minimal downtime.

Compliance & Documentation

- Maintained network documentation, Visio diagrams, and security policies, ensuring seamless operational workflows.
- Conducted network security risk assessments and vulnerability testing, improving overall security posture.
- Worked closely with cross-functional teams to support enterprise network infrastructure, enabling business continuity.